Woven Wellness

Blending regional Indian craft with everyday design, textile maverick Anavila Misra extends her mindful, linen-first philosophy to the home

By AMIT KHANNA

For fashion designer Anavila Misra, the transition from clothing to home textiles was a natural progression of her deep-rooted love for natural materials and mindful luxury. Known for modernising the linen saree, Misra's latest home collection brings that same eco-conscious, tactile philosophy into our closest living spaces—the dining table and the bedroom. "Basically, it is taking and extending what we do in fashion and clothing to home. Nothing beyond that," says Misra, breaking down her vision for a collection that has been quietly brewing for a very long time.

At the heart of this collection is a deep celebration of regional, slow-craft techniques like khatwa (appliqué) and sujini (running stitch), practised by women artisans across Bihar and West Bengal. However, Misra has given these traditional formats a clever, contemporary twist.

"Most of the collection is built around this running stitch. But we've taken floral motifs and done a reverse sujini," she explains. "So you see the negative and the positive. All the negative is full of sujini work and the positives, of course, are the motifs."

While sustainability in fashion is a frequent dinner-table conversation, Misra points out that home textiles often take a backseat in the consumer's mind. It is a gap she wants to plug, especially given how much direct skin contact we have with our bedding. "Most of the time, we spend seven or eight hours on a bed sleeping in direct contact with our bedding. What is it we are sleeping on? Is it natural?" she prompts. Pointing to historical data, she highlights the inherent wellness benefits of linen over synthetics.

Spanning a complete lifestyle gamut—from table runners, placemats and hand-embroidered quote napkins to cushions, throws and quilts—the collection deliberately shuns the loud, flashy embellishments often associated with Indian luxury home decor. "It's very simple. It's not shouting in your face; it doesn't have any rough edges," says Misra, drawing a contrast with heavier, stiffer alternatives.

In a world driven by fast trends, Anavila's home line serves as a gentle reminder that true luxury lies in objects that are good for our well-being, kind to the planet, and deeply rooted in human touch.



Photograph by HARDIK CHHABRA